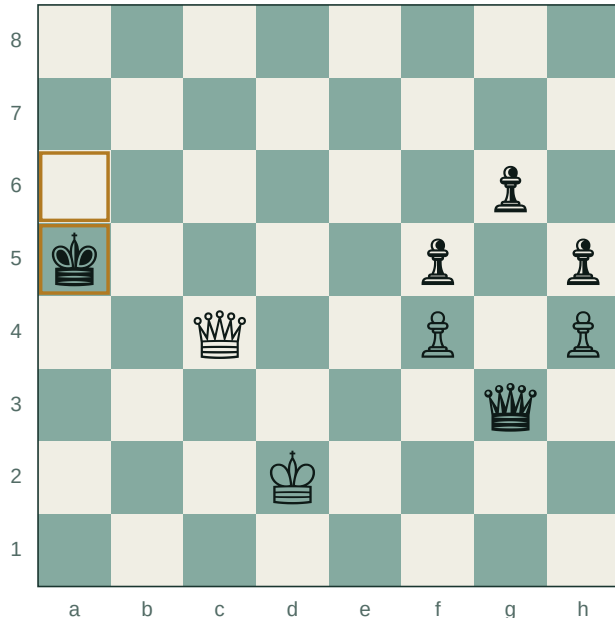


Queen-ending tactics: White, move 57

Queen-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 56...Ka5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

57. Qc3+ Qxc3+ 58. Kxc3

57.Qc3+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. From c3 it attacks king on a5 and queen on g3. Recorded reply: **57...Qxc3+**.

58.Kxc3 The king captures the queen on c3.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on a5. Geometrically undefended: queen on g3. Check for tactical protection.